

# Using CAC Bar Scanner

A step-by-step guide for operators and admins. Keep this open next to the kiosk.

 **Project home:** <https://github.com/NuclearChickens/CAC-Bar-Scanner> · Direct download: <https://github.com/NuclearChickens/CAC-Bar-Scanner/raw/main/BarScanner.exe>

## At a glance

| Tab     | What it's for                                               |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scanner | The main screen. Verdict on every CAC swipe.                |
| Hours   | When the bar is “open” — operating hours or rolling window. |
| Limits  | Max drinks per person per session.                          |
| Roster  | Which DoD categories and branches are allowed to drink.     |
| Banned  | Specific DoD IDs that are denied no matter what.            |
| Reset   | Wipe today's drink counts (requires two CACs).              |
| Logs    | Read-only history of every admin action.                    |
| Backup  | Export or import settings + logs.                           |

All settings tabs are **locked by default**. Two different CAC swipes unlock them for 5 minutes. See [Unlocking settings](#).

## Install — step by step

The first time you set up a PC. You need admin rights on the machine.

- 1 **Download the app.** Open the project home page (URL at the top of this guide) and click the  **Download BarScanner.exe** button near the top. Your browser saves the file to your **Downloads** folder.
- 2 **Open it.** Open File Explorer → **Downloads** → double-click `BarScanner.exe`.
- 3 **Tell Windows to trust it.** If you see a blue *“Windows protected your PC”* box, click **More info** → **Run anyway**. (This appears because the app isn’t code-signed, not because anything is wrong. Windows remembers your choice.)
- 4 **Click “Install” in the first-run dialog.** When the app opens for the first time it asks if it should install for this PC.
- 5 **Approve the UAC prompt.** A blue *User Account Control* box from Windows pops up — click **Yes**.
- 6 **You’re done.** With that one click the app:
  - copied itself into `C:\Program Files\CAC Bar Scanner\`,
  - added itself to the Start menu for every user on the computer,
  - set up the shared data folder at `C:\ProgramData\CACBarScanner\`,
  - registered itself in **Settings** → **Apps** so it can be uninstalled cleanly.

 **Tip:** Once installed, you can safely delete the copy in Downloads. The Start menu and taskbar use the Program Files copy.

## “Not now” instead of Install

If you click **Not now**, the app still runs but only from wherever you double-clicked it, without a Start menu entry or shared data folder. The dialog won’t reappear for the same Windows account, but will appear the next time a *different* user logs in and tries the app. Once anyone clicks **Install**, the offer is dismissed for everyone.

## Launching the app

After install, the easiest way:

- 1 Tap the **Windows key**.

2 Type **Bar**.

3 Press **Enter**.

The app comes up fullscreen. Press **F11** to toggle fullscreen, **Esc** to exit fullscreen, **Ctrl + Q** to quit.

## Scanner tab — the main screen

This is where staff live all night. The cursor is parked in the input box; leave it there. When a CAC is swiped, the 18-character barcode types itself in and a verdict appears in under a second.

### The three verdicts

| Banner                                                                                                  | Meaning                                                       | Counted? |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
|  <b>ALLOWED</b>       | Person is cleared. Banner shows which drink number this is.   | Yes      |
|  <b>DENIED</b>       | Plain-English reason: limit reached, bar closed, banned, etc. | No       |
|  <b>INVALID SCAN</b> | Scanner read garbage. Usually a bad swipe — try again.        | No       |

Denied scans are **not** counted, so a person can't burn through their limit by trying again. Invalid scans aren't recorded at all.

### What else is on the screen

- **Decoded box** — DoD ID, category, branch of the last person scanned, plus a running drink count.
- **Session line at the bottom** — current operating window (e.g. *"Open 17:00 → 02:00"*) so you can confirm the right rules are in effect at a glance.
- **Clear button** — blanks the last decoded result. Handy between customers if you want a clean screen.

If the input box ever loses focus (someone clicked away), just click anywhere on the Scanner tab and it pops back to the input.

## Hours tab — when the bar counts

Controls *when* drinks are counted. Two modes:

| Mode            | What it does                                                                    |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Operating hours | Set an open and close time. Counts reset automatically at next open.            |
| Rolling window  | Count drinks scanned in the last <i>N</i> hours (1 – 168). Slides continuously. |

Switch with the radio button at the top. Fields for the other mode are hidden so you can't edit them by accident.

 **Tip:** If you leave Open and Close both at  in Operating-hours mode, the app treats the bar as open 24 hours.

## Limits tab — drinks per person

One number: the maximum drinks any single person can be served in a session. Default is **3**.

Once a person hits the limit, every subsequent scan from them flashes red with “*You’ve had *N* drinks today (limit *N*)*” until:

- the session ends (Operating-hours mode), or
- the rolling window slides past their earlier drinks (Rolling mode), or
- you do a **manual reset** on the [Reset tab](#).

## Roster tab — who’s eligible

Two side-by-side checklists. A scan is allowed only if **both** its category and branch are checked.

| Column           | Examples                                                 |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Categories (PCC) | Active Duty, Reserve, Retiree, Dependent, Contractor     |
| Branches         | Army, Navy, Marines, Air Force, Space Force, Coast Guard |

Each column has **All** and **None** buttons that flip every box at once — handy for “deny everything and tick on just the few I want.”

---

## Banned tab — block specific people

Deny one specific DoD ID regardless of the roster.

- 1 Type their **10-digit EDIPI** in the EDIPI box.
- 2 Optionally type an **expiry date** as  (e.g.  for “until 31 December 2026”). Leave blank for a permanent ban.
- 3 Click **Add**.

To lift a ban: click the entry in the list, hit **Remove selected**. Expired bans display **(EXPIRED)** in the list but stop denying scans automatically on their expiry date — no manual cleanup needed.

---

## Reset tab — wipe today’s counts

For shift changes or a manual “start the night over.”

- 1 Click **Reset drinks for the day**.
- 2 The first authorizer scans their CAC.
- 3 The second authorizer (must be different) scans theirs.
- 4 All drink counts are wiped immediately.

Every reset is recorded in the **Public reset log** below — that log is permanent and lists both authorizers with the date and time. The log can’t be edited or deleted. This is your accountability trail.

---

## Logs tab — what happened and when

A read-only feed of every admin event:

- Unlocks and locks
- Settings changes (with before/after values)
- Bans added or removed
- Manual resets
- Backup exports

You can't edit or delete entries. Hit **Refresh** to reload after something just happened. This is the place to look when someone asks *“who changed the limit last Thursday?”*

## Backup tab — export and import

The Backup tab does two things:

| Action             | Requires unlock? | Notes                                             |
|--------------------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Export full backup | No               | Saves a <code>.zip</code> of every setting + log. |
| Import full backup | Yes (2 CACs)     | Overwrites all settings and logs on this machine. |

 **Import is destructive.** It **replaces** the current settings and logs with the backup. There's a confirmation dialog before anything is overwritten, but there's no undo afterward.

## Unlocking settings

For everyday scanning, the Scanner tab is always available. Anything that changes configuration sits behind a lock:

- Hours
- Limits
- Roster
- Banned

- Backup → Import

Each locked tab shows a pink banner reading **LOCKED — scan 2 CACs to enable editing.**

## How to unlock

- 1 Click **Unlock** on the banner.
- 2 A small popup appears. The first authorizer scans their CAC.
- 3 The second authorizer (must be different) scans theirs.
- 4 The banner turns green and shows both IDs.
- 5 You have **5 minutes** to make changes before the app auto-locks.
- 6 Click **Lock** on the banner to lock immediately.

Every change you make while unlocked is recorded in the [Logs tab](#) against both authorizing IDs.

## Keyboard shortcuts

| Key             | What it does                                               |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>F11</b>      | Toggle fullscreen (kiosk mode)                             |
| <b>Esc</b>      | Exit fullscreen                                            |
| <b>Ctrl + Q</b> | Quit the app                                               |
| <b>Enter</b>    | Finish a scan manually (most USB scanners do this for you) |

## Where the app stores its data

Everything lives in `C:\ProgramData\CACBarScanner\` — Windows's standard machine-wide application-data folder. The folder is set up during install with read/write access for every user on the PC, which is what makes the configuration shared.

| File                       | What's in it                                            |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>settings.json</code> | Hours, limits, roster, ban list — your configuration.   |
| <code>scans.jsonl</code>   | Running drink counts (one record per scan).             |
| <code>audit.jsonl</code>   | Every admin action — unlocks, changes, resets, exports. |
| <code>resets.jsonl</code>  | Every manual drink reset, with both authorizing IDs.    |

You don't normally need to touch any of these — the app reads and writes them automatically. The **Backup** tab is the supported way to copy or move them.

## Uninstalling

Two ways to start uninstall:

- **Settings** → **Apps** → **Installed apps** → find **CAC Bar Scanner** → click the ⋮ menu → **Uninstall**.
- Or in the **Start menu**, right-click **CAC Bar Scanner** → **Uninstall**.

Either way:

- 1 Windows runs the app one last time in uninstall mode.
- 2 A small dialog asks whether to also delete settings + logs.
  - **Leave unchecked** to keep the data (a future reinstall picks back up where you left off).
  - **Tick the box** for a complete wipe.
- 3 Click **Uninstall** in the dialog.
- 4 Approve the UAC prompt with **Yes**.



The Start menu entry, Add/Remove Programs listing, and `C:\Program Files\CAC Bar Scanner\` folder are all cleaned up. The folder finishes deleting itself on the next reboot — that's normal Windows behavior (the running uninstaller can't delete itself in real time).